

OFFICIAL LANGUAGE

PART XVII SETTLEMENT: OFFICIAL — ARTICLES 343-344 AND THE — ARTICLES 345-347: STATE CHOICE — ARTICLES 348-349: COURTS, JUDGMENTS — ARTICLES 350, 350A, 350B — EIGHTH SCHEDULE, CLASSICAL STATUS

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g2 repaired in place for answer-line and visual-boundary quality • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00 PART XVII SETTLEMENT: OFFICIAL LANGUAGE WITHOUT A NATIONAL LANGUAGE

PART XVII SETTLEMENT OFFICIAL LANGUAGE WITHOUT A NATIONAL LANGUAGE ROOT QUESTION HOW DOES ONE UNION PRESERVE COMMON ADMINISTRATION WITHOUT LINGUISTIC PART XVII CHAPTER I ARTICLES 343-344 UNION LANGUAGE.

ROOT QUESTION

How does one Union preserve common administration without linguistic uniformity?

PART XVII

Chapter I: Articles 343-344

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ROOT QUESTION
- How does one Union preserve common administration without linguistic uniformity?
- PART XVII
- Chapter I: Articles 343-344
- Union language.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Chapter II: Articles 345-347
- regional languages.
- Chapter III: Articles 348-349
- courts and authoritative legal texts.
- Chapter IV: Articles 350-351

CHECK / LIMIT

- grievances, minorities and Hindi development.
- CORE DISTINCTIONS
- Union official language != national language.
- scheduled != official everywhere
- classical != scheduled

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- policy != Constitution.
- Hindi in Devanagari + international form of Indian numerals paired with statutory continuation of English and federal safeguards.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Part XVII distributes Union language, regional languages, court texts and special directives across four chapters, making article-specific location crucial to legal accuracy.

01 ARTICLES 343-344 AND THE STATUTORY CONTINUATION OF ENGLISH

ARTICLES 343-344 AND THE STATUTORY CONTINUATION OF ENGLISH ARTICLE 343 HINDI IN DEVANAGARI OFFICIAL LANGUAGE OF UNION. INTERNATIONAL FORM OF INDIAN NUMERALS OFFICIAL NUMERAL FORM. ENGLISH TRANSITION PERIOD DID NOT CREATE AN AUTOMATIC 1965

OFFICIAL LANGUAGES ACT 1963, AS AMENDED SECTION 3 CONTINUES

ARTICLE 343

Hindi in Devanagari = official language of Union.

International form of Indian numerals = official numeral form.

English transition period did not create an automatic 1965 switch-off.

OFFICIAL LANGUAGES ACT 1963, AS AMENDED section 3 continues English for Union official purposes and

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLE 343
- Hindi in Devanagari = official language of Union.
- International form of Indian numerals = official numeral form.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- English transition period did not create an automatic 1965 switch-off.
- OFFICIAL LANGUAGES ACT 1963, AS AMENDED section 3 continues English for Union official purposes and parliamentary business.
- section 3(5) uses a high-consent legislative lock for specified discontinuance.

CHECK / LIMIT

- ARTICLE 344
- President's Commission at five years and ten years from commencement.
- 30-member constitutional parliamentary committee: 20 Lok Sabha + 10 Rajya Sabha.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- DO NOT COLLAPSE
- Article 344 committee != section 4 statutory Committee on Official Language.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Article 345 allows a State Legislature, subject to Articles 346 and 347, to adopt by law one or more languages in use in the State or Hindi for all or any State official purposes.

02 ARTICLES 345-347: STATE CHOICE AND INTERGOVERNMENTAL COMMUNICATION

ARTICLES 345-347 STATE CHOICE AND INTERGOVERNMENTAL COMMUNICATION ARTICLE 345 STATE LEGISLATURE MAY ADOPT ONE OR MORE LANGUAGES IN ENGLISH CONTINUES UNTIL STATE LAW OTHERWISE PROVIDES WITHIN THE ARTICLE 346 UNION-STATE AND INTER-STATE COMMUNICATION FOLLOWS THE AUTHORISED UNION LANGUAGE ARTICLE 347

ARTICLE 345

State Legislature may adopt one or more languages in use in the State, or Hindi.

English continues until State law otherwise provides within the constitutional frame.

ARTICLE 346

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLE 345
- State Legislature may adopt one or more languages in use in the State, or Hindi.
- English continues until State law otherwise provides within the constitutional frame.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- ARTICLE 346
- Union-State and inter-State communication follows the authorised Union language, subject to agreement permitting Hindi between States.
- ARTICLE 347

CHECK / LIMIT

- President may recognise a language for specified State purposes on substantial-demand grounds.
- Eighth-Schedule inclusion is not a prerequisite for State official-language choice.
- Article 347 is not automatic recognition or a general national-language declaration.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- ARTICLE 346

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Linguistic-minority protection extends beyond the Eighth Schedule, preventing scheduled-language status from becoming the sole measure of constitutional access.

03 ARTICLES 348-349: COURTS, JUDGMENTS AND AUTHORITATIVE TEXTS

ARTICLES 348-349 COURTS, JUDGMENTS AND AUTHORITATIVE TEXTS ARTICLE 348 BASELINE ENGLISH FOR SUPREME COURT AND HIGH COURT PROCEEDINGS UNTIL ENGLISH AUTHORITATIVE TEXTS FOR BILLS, ACTS, ORDINANCES, ORDERS, RULES HIGH COURT PROCEEDINGS GOVERNOR + PREVIOUS PRESIDENTIAL CONSENT HINDI OR STATE OFFICIAL LANGUAGE.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLE 348 BASELINE
- English for Supreme Court and High Court proceedings until Parliament provides otherwise.
- English authoritative texts for Bills, Acts, ordinances, orders, rules and bye-laws.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- HIGH COURT PROCEEDINGS
- Governor + previous presidential consent → Hindi or State official language.
- Article 348(2) expressly excludes judgments, decrees and orders.

CHECK / LIMIT

- SECTION 7 ROUTE authorised non-English High Court judgment/decreed/order in addition to English
- High Court-authorised English translation.
- ARTICLE 349 historically time-bounded special procedure; not a routine present-day gate.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- LIMIT machine or general-information translation is not automatically authoritative law.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Article 348 retains English for Supreme Court and High Court proceedings, preserving national legal continuity despite multilingual administration.

04 ARTICLES 350, 350A, 350B AND 351: ACCESS AND DEVELOPMENT

ARTICLES 350, 350A, 350B AND 351 ACCESS AND DEVELOPMENT ARTICLE 350 REPRESENTATION FOR GRIEVANCE REDRESS MAY USE A ARTICLE 350A ENDEAVOUR TO PROVIDE MOTHER-TONGUE INSTRUCTION FACILITIES AT ARTICLE 350B SPECIAL OFFICER INVESTIGATES SAFEGUARDS REPORTS TO PRESIDENT LAID BEFORE PARLIAMENT AND SENT TO CONCERNED STATE GOVERNMENTS.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLE 350 representation for grievance redress may use a language used in the Union or State.
- ARTICLE 350A endeavour to provide mother-tongue instruction facilities at primary stage for children belonging to linguistic-minority groups.
- ARTICLE 350B

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Special Officer investigates safeguards → reports to President
- laid before Parliament and sent to concerned State governments.
- ARTICLE 351

CHECK / LIMIT

- Union duty to promote Hindi and develop it as a medium for India's composite culture, drawing vocabulary principally
- from Sanskrit and secondarily from other languages.
- BALANCE promotion of Hindi operates with, not above, plural safeguards and federal consent.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Special Officer investigates safeguards → reports to President

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Article 351 promotes Hindi as a medium for India's composite culture, so development of one language cannot be separated from linguistic pluralism.

05 EIGHTH SCHEDULE, CLASSICAL STATUS AND THE THREE-LANGUAGE POLICY BOUNDARY

EIGHTH SCHEDULE, CLASSICAL STATUS AND THE THREE-LANGUAGE POLICY BOUNDARY EIGHTH SCHEDULE 22 LANGUAGES IN THE CURRENT OFFICIAL CONSTITUTION. 14 ORIGINAL ORIYA RENAMED ODIA EFFECT CONSTITUTIONAL RECOGNITION AND ARTICLE 344/351 RELEVANCE. NO AUTOMATIC UNION, STATE, COURT OR SCHOOL-MEDIUM STATUS FOLLOWS. CLASSICAL STATUS SEPARATE UNION EXECUTIVE RECOGNITION.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- EIGHTH SCHEDULE
- 22 languages in the current official Constitution.
- 14 original → Sindhi → Konkani/Manipuri/Nepali → Bodo/Dogri/Maithili/Santhal

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Oriya renamed Odia.
- EFFECT constitutional recognition and Article 344/351 relevance.
- No automatic Union, State, court or school-medium status follows.

CHECK / LIMIT

- CLASSICAL STATUS separate Union executive recognition.
- October 2024 additions brought the official count then reported to eleven.
- THREE-LANGUAGE FORMULA education-policy framework with State implementation variation.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- It is not a constitutional national-language command.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

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FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Scheduled status also carries substantial public-policy and symbolic importance, but it does not make every listed language an "official language of India" for all administrative or judicial purposes.

06 LANGUAGE CASES: COMPETENCE, MINORITY CONTEXT AND PROTECTED CHOICE

LANGUAGE CASES COMPETENCE, MINORITY CONTEXT AND PROTECTED CHOICE GUJARAT UNIVERSITY V. SHRI KRISHNA (1963) MEDIUM/LANGUAGE POWER MUST D.A.V. COLLEGE V. STATE OF PUNJAB (1971) LINGUISTIC-MINORITY SAFEGUARDS STATE OF KARNATAKA V. ASSOCIATED MANAGEMENT (2014) COMPULSORY MOTHER-TONGUE DOCTRINAL TRIANGLE LEGISLATIVE COMPETENCE SPEECH/CHOICE RIGHTS LINGUISTIC-MINORITY SAFEGUARDS.

Gujarat University v. Shri Krishna (1963) medium/language power must respect the Union-State education competence boundary.

D.A.V. College v. State of Punjab (1971) linguistic-minority safeguards require contextual constitutional analysis.

State of Karnataka v. Associated Management (2014) compulsory mother-tongue medium cannot override protected educational choice.

DOCTRINAL TRIANGLE legislative competence

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- Gujarat University v. Shri Krishna (1963) medium/language power must respect the Union-State education competence boundary.
- D.A.V. College v. State of Punjab (1971) linguistic-minority safeguards require contextual constitutional analysis.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- State of Karnataka v. Associated Management (2014) compulsory mother-tongue medium cannot override protected educational choice.
- DOCTRINAL TRIANGLE legislative competence

CHECK / LIMIT

- speech/choice rights
- linguistic-minority safeguards.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- LIMIT none of these decisions declares a national language or erases Article 350A.
- Gujarat University v. Shri Krishna (1963) medium/language power must respect the Union-State education competence boundary.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Listing does not automatically make a language the Union language, a State language, a court language, a school medium or a classical language.

07 FEDERAL ACCOMMODATION, COURT ACCESS AND TRANSLATION TECHNOLOGY

FEDERAL ACCOMMODATION, COURT ACCESS AND TRANSLATION TECHNOLOGY LEGITIMATE GOALS ADMINISTRATIVE INTEROPERABILITY CITIZEN ACCESS CULTURAL RECOGNITION JUDICIAL USABILITY EDUCATIONAL INCLUSION. RISKS IMPOSITION EXCLUSION FROM EMPLOYMENT/SERVICES TRANSLATION ERROR AUTHORITATIVE-TEXT CONFUSION

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- LEGITIMATE GOALS administrative interoperability
- citizen access
- cultural recognition judicial usability
- educational inclusion.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- RISKS imposition
- exclusion from employment/services
- translation error authoritative-text confusion
- weak minority facilities

CHECK / LIMIT

- digital language divide.
- TECHNOLOGY CHAIN multilingual intake → translation/interpretation → human legal review
- authority label → version control → accessible publication.
- FEDERAL METHOD consent + capacity + phased implementation + reciprocal communication.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- LIMIT policy targets, committee recommendations and software outputs do not amend Part XVII.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: English in higher courts supports a common precedential and inter-State legal medium, but it can distance litigants and many lawyers from the language of adjudication.

08 UPSC TRAPS, VERIFIED PYQ AND QUALIFIED ANSWER SYNTHESIS

UPSC TRAPS, VERIFIED PYQ AND QUALIFIED ANSWER SYNTHESIS PRELIMS FIREWALL OFFICIAL 22 SCHEDULED LANGUAGES HINDI SCRIPT DEVANAGARI NUMERALS INTERNATIONAL FORM ENGLISH CONTINUATION ARTICLE 348(2) EXCLUDES JUDGMENTS

PRELIMS FIREWALL official != national

22 scheduled languages

Hindi script = Devanagari numerals = international form

English continuation = statute

Article 348(2) excludes judgments

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- PRELIMS FIREWALL official != national
- 22 scheduled languages
- Hindi script = Devanagari numerals = international form
- English continuation = statute

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Article 348(2) excludes judgments
- section 7 supplies separate route
- Article 350 grievance right
- 350A instruction facility

CHECK / LIMIT

- 350B Special Officer classical and three-language categories are separate.
- 2024 PRELIMS ROUTE
- 21st, 71st and 92nd Amendment language additions.
- MAINS SPINE constitutional compromise → Part XVII → 1963 Act

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- State autonomy → court/text hierarchy → minority safeguards
- category distinctions → access technology → federal verdict.
- CONCLUSION multilingual unity requires exact law, consent and authoritative parity.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — category distinctions → access technology → federal verdict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Classical status does not itself alter Part XVII, the Eighth Schedule, State official-language law or Article 348.

E EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT PART A — LANGUAGE OF THE UNION (ARTS 343-344) PART B — REGIONAL LANGUAGES (ARTS 345-347) PART C — LANGUAGE OF JUDICIARY & LAWS (ARTS PART D — SPECIAL DIRECTIVES (ARTS 350-351) PART E — THE EIGHTH SCHEDULE ART 343

HINDI IN DEVANAGARI SCRIPT

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE

- PART A — LANGUAGE OF THE UNION (Arts 343-344)
- PART B — REGIONAL LANGUAGES (Arts 345-347)
- PART C — LANGUAGE OF JUDICIARY & LAWS (Arts 348-349)
- PART D — SPECIAL DIRECTIVES (Arts 350-351)

ADVANCED LIMIT

- PART E — THE EIGHTH SCHEDULE
- Art 343: Hindi in Devanagari script = official language of the Union; numerals = international
- English to continue for 15 years (1950-1965); Parliament may extend its use beyond that.
- Language Commissions (5th & 10th year; first under B.G. Kher (1955); examined by a parliamentary

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- Official Languages Act, 1963 → allows English indefinitely (no time limit) alongside Hindi;
- Constitution does not specify states' official languages → a state legislature may adopt any language(s)
- A state's choice is NOT limited to the Eighth Schedule (e.g., states have adopted non-8th-Schedule tongues).
- Art 347: On demand, if a substantial population wants it, the President may direct official recognition of

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.